
The Alpha Pack Protocol
A Forensic Analysis of a High-Profit-Factor NQ Opening Range Strategy

The Hunter's Paradox

We hunt for asymmetry, not for frequency. Our strength lies in the ruthless efficiency of the hunt, not the number of attempts.

Conventional Wisdom

Widen stops to survive market noise and increase win rate.

Our Data-Driven Reality

Winning NQ trades move decisively and immediately. Our forensic data shows 85% of large winning trades never experience a drawdown greater than 5 points.

The 'Sniper' Thesis

We use an ultra-tight Maximum Adverse Excursion (MAE) of 0.05% as a filter. Any trade that moves against us by this amount is statistically identified as a 'Trap' or 'Chop' and is cut instantly.

This creates many small, manageable losses paid for by a few outsized wins.

The Playbook: Rules of Engagement

1. THE SETUP (09:30 EST)

Instrument: NQ / MNQ Futures

Timeframe: 1-Minute Chart

Action: Define the Opening Range (OR) as the High & Low of the first 1-minute candle (09:30:00 - 09:30:59).

2. THE TRIGGER (ENTRY)

Long Trigger: A 1-minute candle closes *above* the OR High.

Short Trigger: A 1-minute candle closes *below* the OR Low.

3. THE STALK (FILTERS)

Range Filter: If OR height > 0.25%, the market is too volatile. **No Trade.**

Doji Filter: If the signal candle's body is < 50% of its total range, it indicates indecision and a high probability of a "fakeout." **No Trade.**

The Alpha’s Command: Exit Protocol

Primary Exits (The Failed Hunt)

- **Strict MAE Stop**: A hard stop is placed at 0.05% MAE from entry (approx. 10-12 pts). This is our core momentum filter. If a trade moves against us by this amount, it is cut instantly.
- **Range Re-entry (‘Strict Exit’)**: If price closes *back inside* the Opening Range after a breakout, the move has failed. **Exit Immediately.** This is the most robust exit variant, proven to drastically reduce drawdown.

Profit Targets (The Successful Hunt)

- ***TP1** (Scalp): 10-15 points. Secures initial profit and positive cash flow.
- ***TP2 (Runner):** Trail the remaining position using market structure or a fixed target with a >2:1 Risk:Reward ratio.

The Alpha's Edge: Performance Scorecard (MNQ)

1.85
Profit Factor

8.93
System Quality Number (SQN)

27.8%
Win Rate

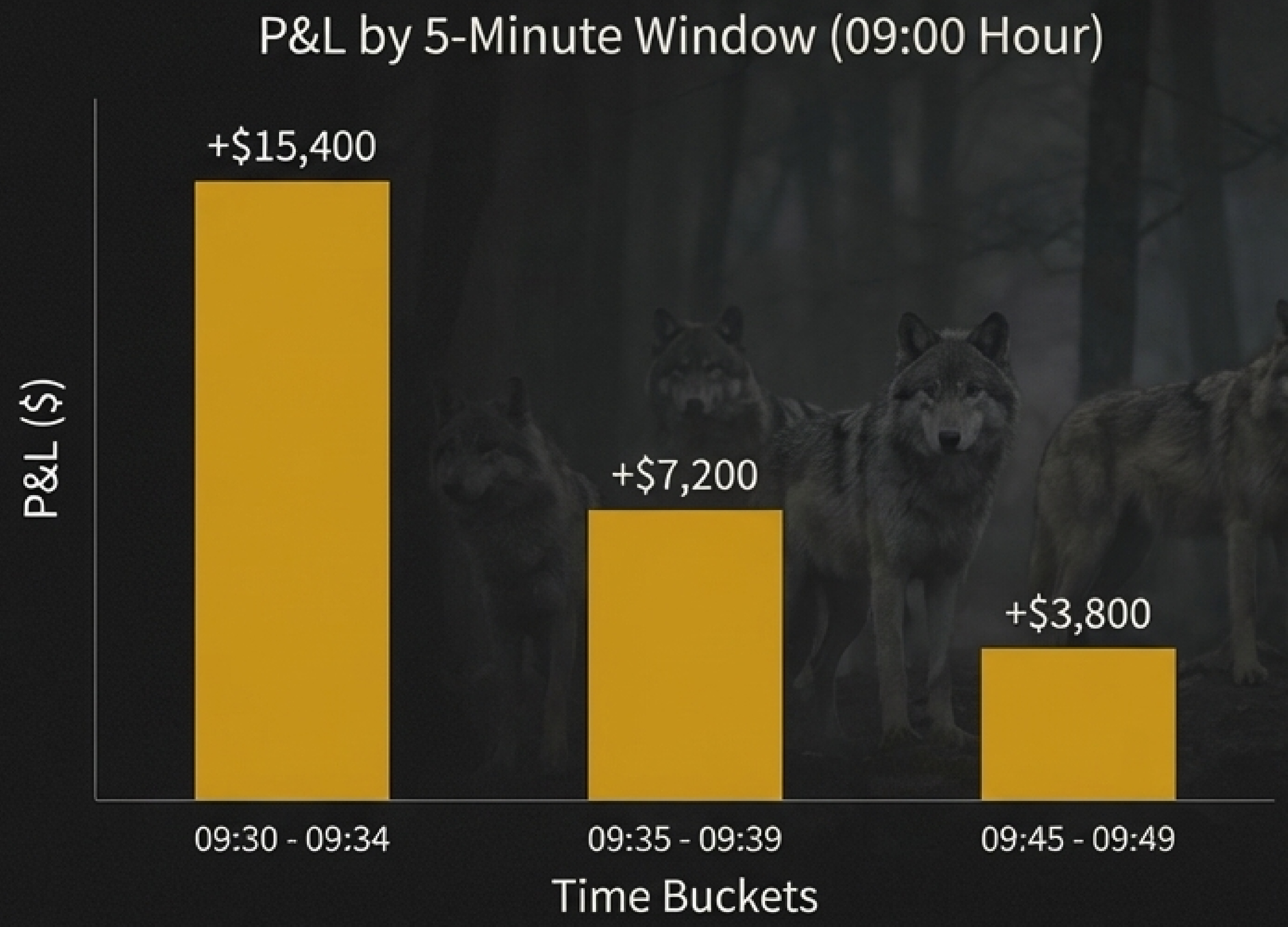
-$1,334
Max Drawdown

22
Average Losing Streak

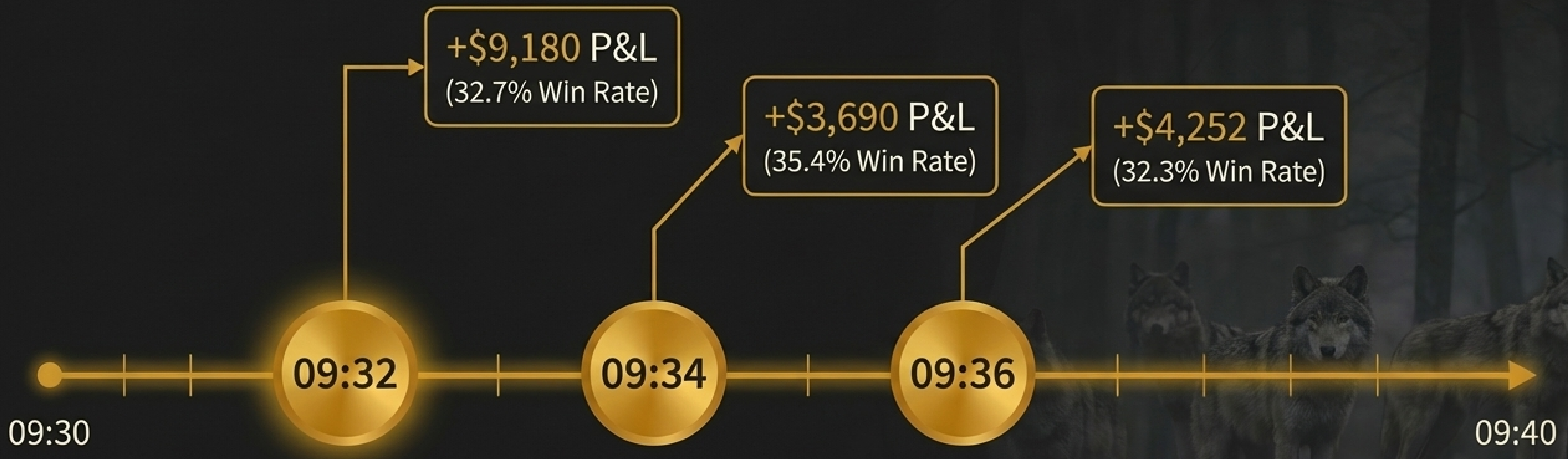
A low win rate is the mathematical cost of a high profit factor. This system is optimized for profitability and drawdown control, not for emotional comfort.

The 09:00 Hour: Mapping the Kill Zone

Over 80% of the strategy’s total P&L is generated in the first 30 minutes of the session. This is not an all-day strategy; it is a precision strike at the open.



The Golden Minutes: When the Pack Strikes



The single minute of 9:32 AM EST accounts for over 20% of the system's entire historical profit. This is the moment of maximum edge, representing the 'Follow-Through' variance where the initial auction balance breaks.

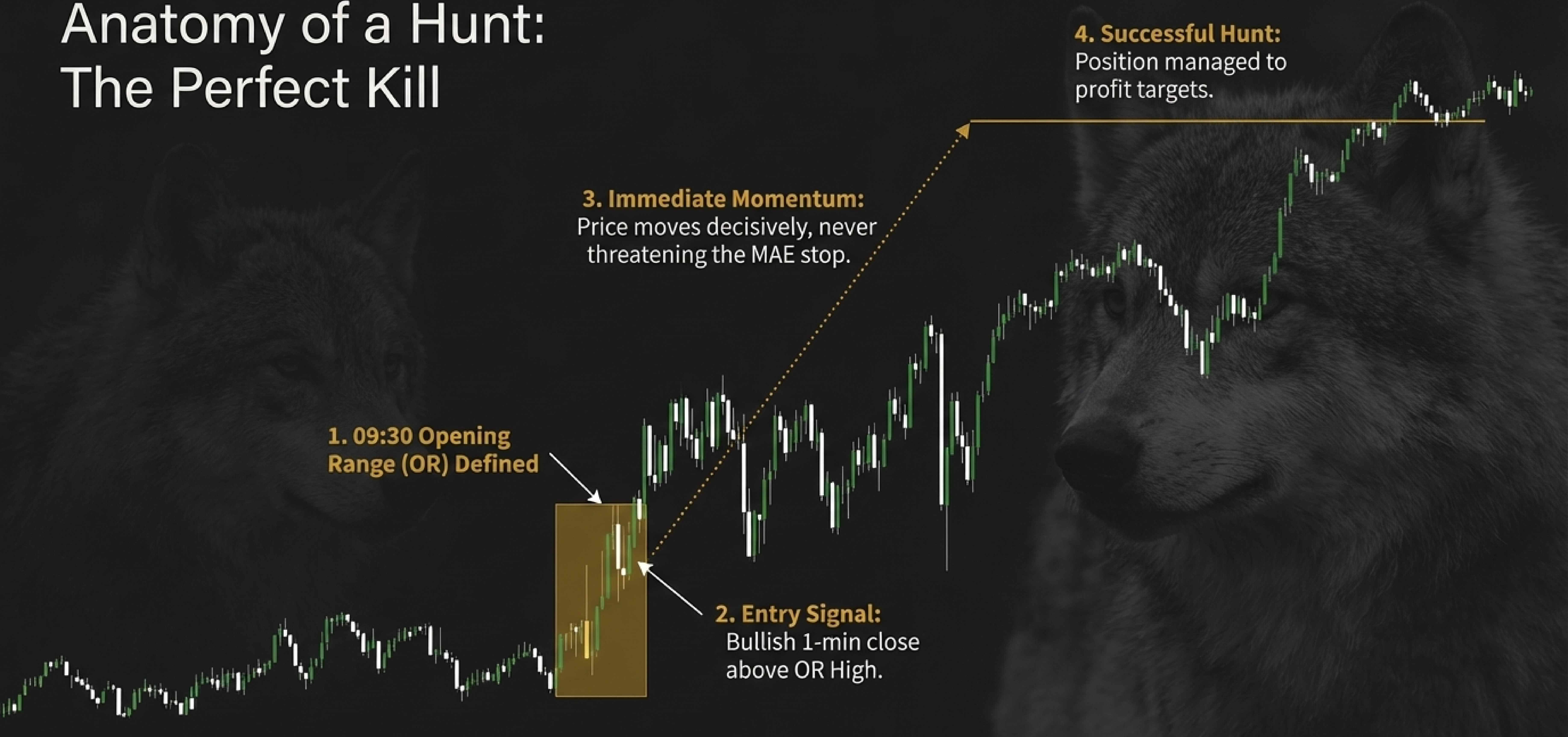
The Toxic Minutes: When the Pack Waits

The data is equally clear on when *not* to hunt. Avoiding these statistically negative expectancy windows is as crucial to long-term profitability as exploiting the golden ones.

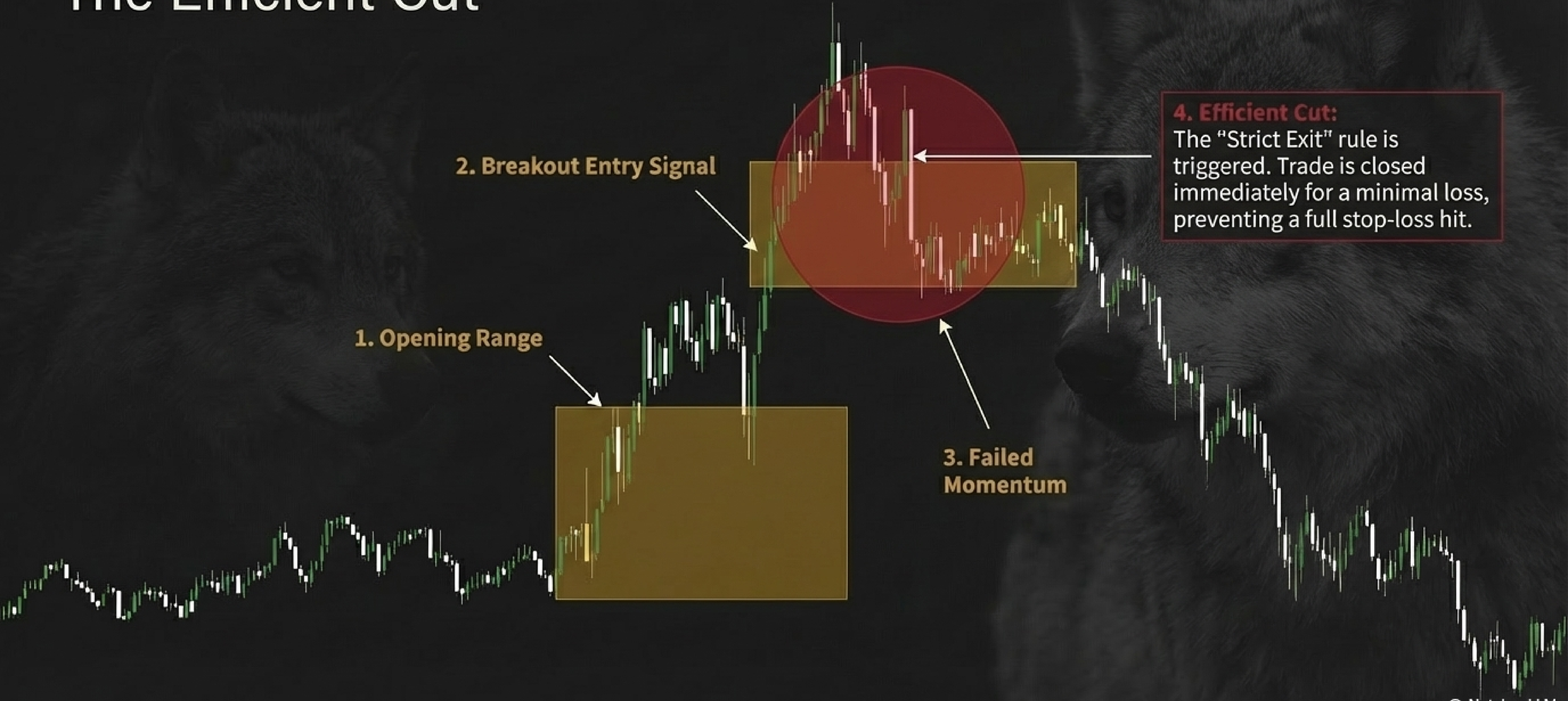
Shifting Terrain: Performance Outside the Kill Zone

- **10:00 Hour**
  Profitable (~$7.3k P&L), but less explosive than the open. Contains negative-expectancy pockets like the 10:10-10:14 window (-$380 P&L).
- **11:00 Hour**
  Markedly weaker (~$1.8k P&L). The market enters a different regime.
- **12:00 Hour (The 'Dead Zone')**
  Net neutral-to-negative expectancy (~$23 P&L). The 'Lunch Hour Chop' actively works against this breakout logic. **Strictly avoid.**

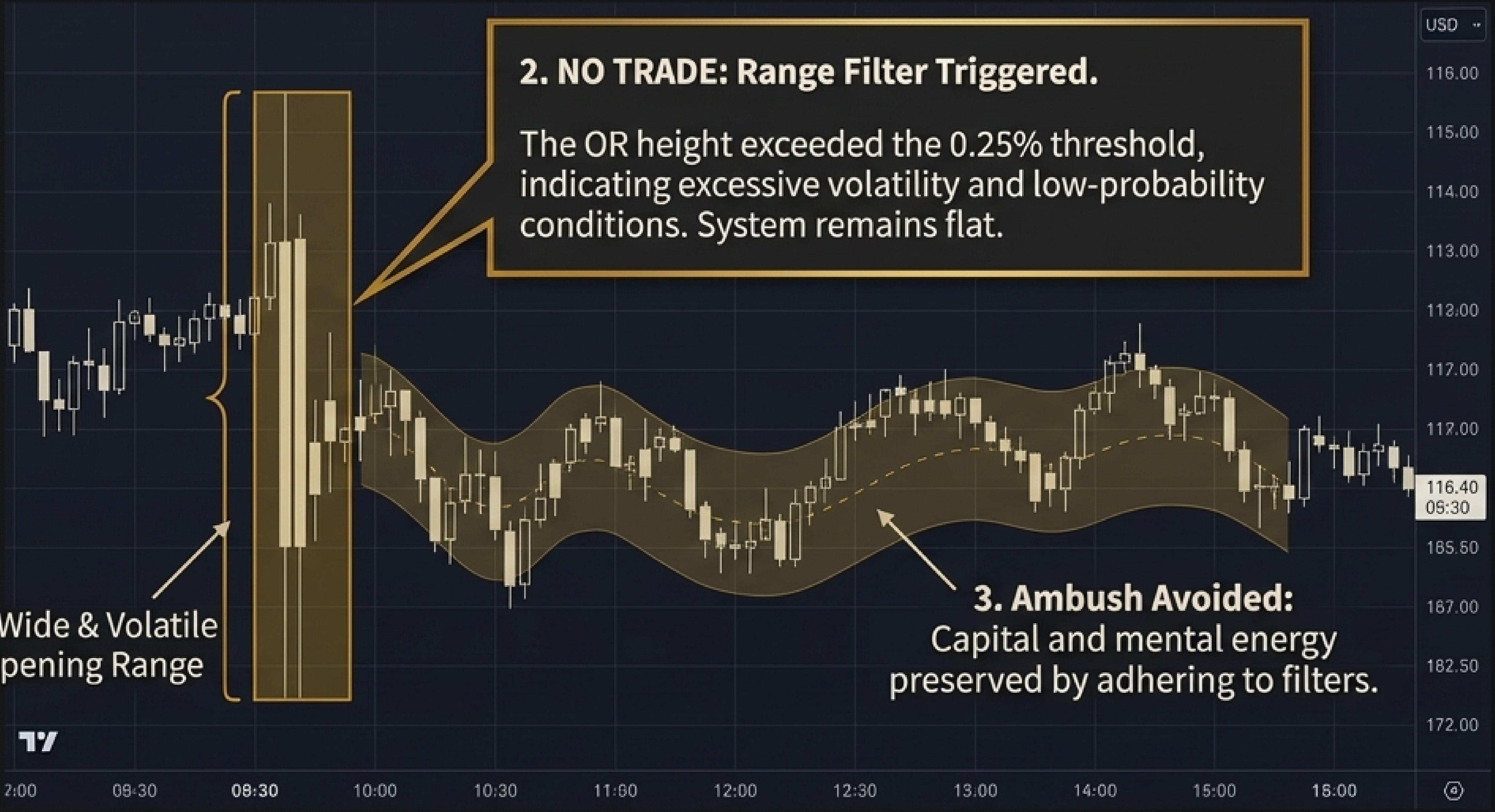
Anatomy of a Hunt: The Perfect Kill



Anatomy of a Hunt: The Efficient Cut



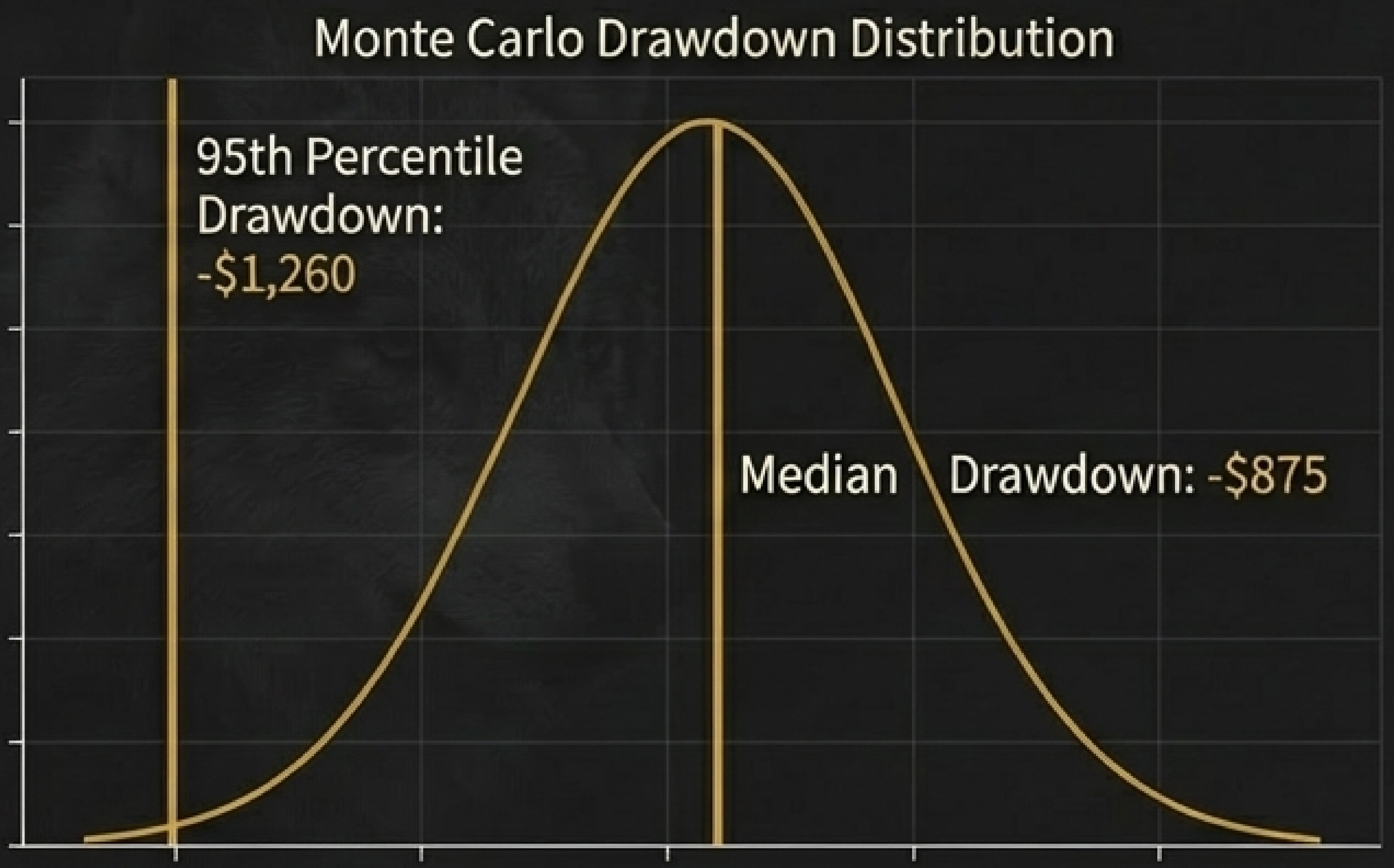
Anatomy of a Hunt: The Avoided Ambush



TradingView

Reference

Survival of the Fittest: Risk Profile & Viability



Monte Carlo Simulation Results

- Median Drawdown: -$875
- 95th Percentile Drawdown: -$1,260

Proprietary Firm Sizing Recommendation

Size: 2 Micro Contracts (MNQ) per $50k of evaluation capital.

Risk of Ruin (<$2k drawdown): 0.8%

Psychological Note: The primary challenge is discipline. The system is designed to withstand an average losing streak of 22 trades. The math works, but only if the trader can execute flawlessly.

The Alpha Pack Protocol: Summary

Philosophy: Hunt for asymmetric rewards with a ‘sniper’ mindset. Use the tight 0.05% MAE stop as a momentum filter, not just a stop loss.

Execution: Trade the 1-minute Opening Range Breakout, strictly adhering to the >0.25% Range Filter and <50% Doji Body Filter.

Timing: Be aggressive in the ‘Golden Window’ (09:30-09:40 EST), especially at 09:32. Be disciplined and avoid “Toxic Minutes”” and the 12:00 hour “Dead Zone.”

Risk: Implement the ‘Strict Exit’ rule without hesitation. Manage position size to maintain a <1% Risk of Ruin based on the system’s drawdown profile.


Discussion
NotebookLM